

HONEYCOMB BAKERY RVA

Website Notes and Feature Requests for Joel McCarthy

Last updated: February 2026

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

Joel McCarthy manages the Honeycomb Bakery RVA website (honeycombbakeryrva.com) including the site repo and hosting cluster. This document tracks outstanding issues, recent fixes, and planned changes. Text Aiden first for urgent issues; use this doc for anything non-urgent.

CURRENT STATUS (February 2026)

Site is live and functional. BigCommerce storefront is dormant until October 2026 (next gift-box season). Instagram links on the homepage are working. Menu page updated November 2025. No active incidents.

RESOLVED ISSUES

October 2023 -- Homepage took 9+ seconds to load on mobile
Resolved November 2023. Joel compressed images and switched to lazy loading.

January 2024 -- Contact form not sending emails to bakery address
Resolved January 2024. SMTP config issue. Joel fixed same day.

March 2024 -- BigCommerce gift-box checkout broken (double-billing on shipping)
Resolved March 2024. Stripe webhook config error. Joel debugged and fixed before the issue affected any customers.

June 2024 -- SSL certificate expired; site showing security warning
Resolved June 2024. Joel renewed the cert. Should auto-renew going forward, but Joel to double-check.

October 2024 -- Etsy link on homepage pointed to a deleted listing
Resolved October 2024. Updated by Joel to main Honeycomb Etsy shop URL.

December 2024 -- Gift-box pre-order page crashed during peak traffic (80+ simultaneous visitors, November 30)
Resolved December 2024. Joel moved hosting to a larger tier on his cluster. Fixed for the 2025 season.

February 2025 -- GF menu page had incorrect allergen statement (said "may contain wheat")
Resolved February 2025. Content error corrected by Aiden with Joel's help.

November 2025 -- Klaviyo abandoned-cart integration stopped firing after a BigCommerce update
Resolved November 12, 2025. Klaviyo webhook URL needed to be re-registered. Lost some early-season abandoned cart flow.

OPEN ISSUES

Menu page text overlap on older Android browsers (January 2026)

Priority: Low. Affects a small percentage of users. Joel will look at it when he has time.

Instagram feed widget not updating (February 2026)

Priority: Medium. Shows last post from November 2025. May be an API token issue. Joel to investigate when available.

SSL auto-renewal not confirmed (February 2026)

Priority: High. Joel renewed manually in June 2024. Should be set to auto-renew but this has not been confirmed. Add a calendar reminder for October 2026 to verify with Joel before the cert expires.

PLANNED FEATURES (for October 2026 gift-box season launch)

BigCommerce gift-box shop: confirm all SKUs, images, and shipping rules are updated for 2026 pricing.

Priority: High. Aiden to send Joel updated SKU list and prices by October 1.

Klaviyo abandoned cart: register new webhook URL before October 15 launch.

Priority: High. Did not do this early enough in 2025. Start by October 1.

Dedicated GF line page explaining the separated prep area.

Priority: Medium. Aiden writes copy; Joel builds the page. Good for celiac customers searching specifically for GF bread options.

Google Analytics on BigCommerce site.

Priority: Medium. Currently no tracking. Joel to set up GA4 tag.

Mailing list signup embedded on homepage.

Priority: Medium. Currently requires a click-through. Embedded form would help grow the subscriber list.

Update staff photo on About page -- current photo is from 2023.

Priority: Low. Kenji is in the photo. Get a new one taken.

Add a Wholesale page with basic info and a contact form.

Priority: Low. Currently no wholesale info on the website. Would reduce cold inbound messages from cafes.

HOSTING NOTES

Provider: Joel's private cluster (Hetzner Cloud, EU region -- Joel manages)

Uptime in 2025: One outage in November (30 minutes, during peak gift-box season). Joel resolved remotely.

Cost to Aiden: Joel has not charged for hosting since the site launched. This needs to be formalized in 2026 -- either a flat monthly rate or a gift-box season fee. Aiden to discuss with Joel before October 2026.

CONTACT

Urgent (site down, checkout broken): text Joel at 804-555-0519

Non-urgent: email joelmccarthy.it@gmail.com or update this doc

Joel's availability note: Joel is an IT employee at his day job and sometimes

has delayed response on weekends. For bakery-season issues, agree on availability windows in advance.